



Graduate Education in Psychology Handbook

Fall 2024

Department of Psychology
Iowa State University

Revised Jan 2025

Contents

GRADUATE EDUCATION OBJECTIVES, REQUIREMENTS, POLICIES, AND PROCEDURES	2
Objectives.....	2
MAJOR PROFESSOR AND ACADEMIC PLAN COMMITTEE.....	2
Definitions and Functions.....	2
Procedures for Change of Major Professor	3
Procedures for Change of Program Area.....	3
Procedures for Creating and Changing an Academic Plan	4
Formation of the Master's Academic Plan Committee	4
Formation of the Doctoral Academic Plan Committee	4
Policy Regarding Major Professors in Absence	5
Course Requirements	5
GRADUATE MINOR IN PSYCHOLOGY	7
CO-MAJOR IN PSYCHOLOGY	7
CERTIFICATE IN QUANTITATIVE PSYCHOLOGY	9
RESEARCH TRAINING IN PSYCHOLOGY.....	10
RESEARCH COMPLIANCE	10
THESIS AND DISSERTATION.....	10
DOCTORAL PROGRAM ADMISSION AND CANDIDACY	11
Doctoral Student - Department Classification	11
Doctoral Candidacy - Graduate College Classification	12
The Written Doctoral Qualifying Examination	12
The Doctoral Preliminary Oral Examination	14
STUDENT PROGRESS AND EVALUATION.....	15
Expected Timeline for Department of Psychology Graduate Students	15
Minimum Timeline for Graduate Student Annual Review Evaluation	17
Appeal of Recommendation	18
Grievances.....	18
Checklist and Timetable.....	18
GRADUATE ASSISTANTSHIPS, REGISTRATION, AND TUITION SCHOLARSHIPS	20
Graduate Assistantship and Other Funding Criteria	21
Graduate Assistantship Benefits	21
Leave of Absence for Graduate Students	22
Short-Term Absence	22
Graduate Assistantship Tuition Scholarships.....	23
Graduate Student Awards.....	23
University Research Excellence Awards	23
University Teaching Excellence Awards.....	23
Department of Psychology Research Enhancement Awards	24
Department of Psychology Graduate Student Excellence Awards	25
Department of Psychology Travel Funding	25
David Campbell/Fred Borgen Psychology Graduate Student International Travel Fund	25
Baumann Summer Scholarship	26
Dissertation Enhancement Grants.....	27
MISCELLANEOUS DUTY POOL (MDP).....	28
GLOSSARY	30
ANNUAL STUDENT REVIEW SUMMARY REPORT	31
MASTER'S ACADEMIC PLAN COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION FOR CONTINUATION TO DOCTORAL STUDIES	41

GRADUATE EDUCATION OBJECTIVES, REQUIREMENTS, POLICIES, AND PROCEDURES

Objectives

The roles of psychologists can be classified into three categories: educator, investigator, and practitioner. Individuals may focus on one or any combination of these roles. The objective of the Graduate Program in Psychology at Iowa State University (ISU) is to direct the education of students to meet the general requirements indicated by their goals and to develop their competency and expertise to meet those goals.

The department offers education leading to two degrees: Master of Science (M.S.) and Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.). The graduate faculty of the department has agreed to focus upon Ph.D. studies in three areas: cognitive, counseling, and social. The graduate faculty of each specialty area has prepared a program of study and experiences to meet the requirements of students in that program. According to the learning goals of graduate training in psychology, graduates of the program will learn to:

1. Demonstrate comprehensive understanding of scientific literature in the student's training area.
2. Form testable hypotheses and articulate research objectives that have the potential to lead to significant scientific contributions to the field of study.
3. Conduct quantitative research via appropriate acquisition, analysis, and reporting of data.
4. Effectively communicate research findings orally and in writing.
5. Adhere to ethical principles and demonstrate professionalism in research and/or practice.

Students with a bachelor's or master's degree may apply directly to any of the Ph.D. programs. Students entering without a master's degree would complete all requirements for a thesis-based M.S. degree and receive that degree in progressing toward the Ph.D. degree.

This document includes only those policies and requirements that are common to all graduate students in the department. Thus, this document states the necessary, but not sufficient, requirements for the degrees. An attempt has been made to include the current, commonly used requirements and procedures of the Graduate College, but further detail may be required. Additional reference documents include the:

[Graduate College Handbook](#)
[Policy on Discrimination and Harassment](#)

MAJOR PROFESSOR AND ACADEMIC PLAN COMMITTEE

Definitions and Functions

(last modified September 2015)

A student's major professor is the graduate student's advisor. The major professor must be a member of the graduate faculty and serves as chair of the student's Academic Plan Committee (APC). Students must have a major professor to remain in good standing for the program. In general, the major professor is an expert in the area of specialization in which the student is enrolled. The Academic Plan is a listing of courses and research credits required for the individual's degree. It is a plan for course work, a vehicle for goal setting, and an agreement between the student and the Graduate College. The Academic Plan delineates, in conjunction with existing department and Graduate College regulations, the requirements for a graduate degree. The APC ensures that departmental and Graduate College requirements are met by the proposed Academic Plan. Thus, selection of an APC, and particularly a major professor, are important decisions for the student, as these faculty members greatly influence the student's progress towards a degree.

It is the major professor who likely will have the most direct and continuous contact with the student. Specifically, the major professor:

- 1) serves as an advisor and mentor for the student.
- 2) guides and directs the student's research and writing of the thesis and/or dissertation.
- 3) facilitates procedural matters (i.e., guiding course selection and signing university forms).
- 4) chairs and coordinates meetings of the student's APC.

- 5) recommends to the departmental faculty and Graduate Dean changes in the student's status, such as removal from probation, change in advisory status, extending degree requirements, and approving minor changes to the Academic Plan.
- 6) presents the student at graduation and writes letters of recommendation for future study or employment.

The multiple roles of the advisor delineated above, and their importance to the student, highlight that the relationship between the major professor and the student is very important. Discussions about congruence of research interests and compatibility of expectations for graduate study should be held early and often. Specifically, all major professors and their graduate students will complete an Onboarding Expectations and Development Plan during the student's first semester. Discussions regarding the mentor-mentee relationship should occur regularly and are expected to occur during the Annual Evaluation Process.

In addition to the functions performed by the major professor, the APC also serves to aid the student in a number of ways. The Committee guides and evaluates the student during graduate study. Among the Committee's duties are periodically reviewing the progress of the student, advising the student during the development of the Academic Plan and research program, and considering any major changes in the student's Academic Plan (e.g., changing the major or minor, changing thesis or dissertation topics, or changing courses). The Committee reads the thesis, dissertation, or research project report, administers the respective oral examinations for the thesis, dissertation, or research project report, and conducts the oral preliminary examination (for Ph.D. candidates).

To maximally foster a student's graduate career, early appointment of the APC and development of an official Academic Plan are imperative. For students entering without a master's degree, the APC must be formed, and an official Academic Plan must be filed with the Graduate College during the first or second semester of graduate study. (This is strongly recommended for students who enter with a master's degree, but it is not required during the first year.) In no case can the committee be formed later than the semester before the preliminary oral examination (doctoral candidates) or final oral examination (master's candidates).

The major professor and APC are recommended to the Graduate College by the Director of Graduate Education (DOGE) and the student by means of the Workday system. The Academic Plan must be electronically approved by the major professor, all members of the Committee, the DOGE, and the student. Students should review the Graduate College deadlines for approval of the Academic Plan.

A student who has completed a master's thesis (or equivalency) and is forming a doctoral APC may declare a minor. The student should consult with their major professor about the advisability of the minor. If a minor is being declared, a graduate faculty member from the minor field must serve on the APC. The major professor and the representative from the minor field may not be the same person.

Procedures for Change of Major Professor

Although changing one's major professor is rare in our department, students may change their major professor during the program. Such a change is best made early in the program of study rather than later. To promote good communication and transparency among all concerned parties, a student who is considering changing major professors should first discuss their intent to switch with their current major professor. Issues related to alleged discrimination or harassment should be reported to the [Office of Equal Opportunity](#). Issues related to ethical conduct in research (e.g., fabrication of data) may be directed to the DOGE or Department Chair and/or consult with the [University's Research Integrity Officer](#) (rio@iastate.edu).

Neither the current major professor nor the Area Director/DOGE can prevent a student from making a desired change of major professor. However, students should be aware that faculty are not obligated to take on a student who requests to be their advisee.

If a change in major professor is ultimately desired, the student is responsible for contacting and obtaining approval from the new major professor to make the switch. At this point, the student must consult with the DOGE. The new major professor will assume the role of the student's Academic Plan Committee chair, and this change must be finalized through a change to the student's Academic Plan, which must be approved by the DOGE and the Graduate College.

Procedures for Change of Program Area

Students must be affiliated with a program area within the department. Students wishing to change to a new major professor affiliated with a different program than the one they were admitted into should discuss this with the DOGE. This may require a change of program area on the part of the student that includes formal steps of application and may occur in competition with other applying students. Admission to a new program area is not guaranteed. Any exceptions to this process require consultation with the DOGE.

Procedures for Creating and Changing an Academic Plan

Each student's Academic Plan should be designed to correct deficiencies in academic preparation; allow study of subject matter that most interests the student; include courses, research, and practica that are required by the department; and avoid repetition in areas where the student is well prepared. The Academic Plan Committee assures that departmental requirements are met.

The Academic Plan specifies the coursework that will be taken for the master's and/or doctoral degree. The course list associated with the Academic Plan should be submitted in Workday after the student has an approved APC. The student will be notified when the Graduate College has approved the Academic Plan.

Changes to the Academic Plan (or the APC) in Workday are permitted with appropriate approval. Such changes may include course substitutions, change of thesis topic, change of area of study, change of major professor, change of Committee members, and deletion or addition of a minor. Modifications to the Academic Plan shall have the electronic approval of the student, the major professor, all other Committee members, and the DOGE. Changes to the APC must be approved by the Dean of the Graduate College before the preliminary or final oral examination is held.

The following three sections describe the faculty membership requirements for the Master's and Doctoral Academic Plan Committees. See also Chapter 6 of the Graduate College Handbook.

Formation of the Master's Academic Plan Committee

The Master's Academic Plan Committee consists of at least three members of the graduate faculty, one whom must be from a different field of emphasis to ensure diversity of perspectives (defined in Chapter 6 of the Graduate College Handbook). An Associate member of the Graduate Faculty may participate in the direction of a student's master's research in a co-major professor arrangement, under which both the Associate Graduate Faculty and a full member of the Graduate Faculty, who is co-major professor, jointly accept responsibility for direction of the master's research. All tenured or tenure-eligible faculty are members of the Graduate Faculty; teaching faculty may apply for Associate membership on the Graduate Faculty (see the Graduate College Handbook Appendix G). The APC should be officially formed, and an Academic Plan should be developed and filed with the Graduate College by the second semester of graduate study. In no case can the Committee be formed later than the term before the final oral examination for the master's. A majority of members of the Committee should have their primary affiliation in the Department of Psychology.

Formation of the Doctoral Academic Plan Committee

The Doctoral Academic Plan Committee consists of at least five members of the graduate faculty. It must include at least three members, including the major professor, from within the student's major or program area. The Committee must include at least one member from a different field of emphasis to ensure diversity of perspectives (defined in Chapter 6 of the Graduate College Handbook). An Associate member of the Graduate Faculty may participate in the direction of a student's dissertation research in a co-major professor arrangement, under which both the Associate member and a full member of the Graduate Faculty, who is co-major professor, jointly accept responsibility for direction of the dissertation. All tenured or tenure-eligible faculty are members of the Graduate Faculty; teaching faculty may apply for Associate membership of the Graduate Faculty (see the Graduate College Handbook Appendix G). Faculty membership on Master's and Doctoral Academic Plan Committees for a given student may be the same or entirely different. Ideally, the Committee should be officially formed, and an Academic Plan should be developed and filed with the Graduate College during the second semester after the completion of the master's degree or the third semester of graduate study in the case of a student entering with a master's degree from another university. The APC must be approved by the Graduate College no later than the term before the preliminary oral examination.

For additional resources regarding completion of the Academic Plan Committee and Academic Plan, see:
<https://www.grad-college.iastate.edu/resources/workday>.

Policy Regarding Major Professors in Absence

When faculty plan to retire or leave ISU for another position, they should meet with each of their graduate student advisees to discuss their own role in the student's continuing graduate study in Psychology at ISU. If the faculty member does not intend to remain active in advising the student and supervising the student's research, they should assist the student in identifying and securing an appropriate replacement as chair of the student's Academic Plan Committee. If the faculty member intends to remain active in supervising the student's research, then they should assist the student in identifying and securing an appropriate on-campus co-chair for the student's APC. Generally, the co-chair would be a faculty member who is already serving on the Committee. When the departing faculty member remains on the APC as a co-chair, they would be expected to participate in both oral prelims and final defenses. The on-campus co-chair would handle administrative details and provide advising regarding the student's ongoing Academic Plan.

Faculty taking a Faculty Professional Development Assignment (FPDA) should also meet with each of their graduate student advisees to discuss their availability and role in advising the student during the leave. No special arrangements are necessary if the faculty member will remain active in advising a student's research and: (a) no proposal meetings, oral examinations, or final defenses are planned during the leave, or (b) the major professor will be available for any proposal meetings, oral examinations, or final defenses. If the major professor will be unable to participate in any way in such meetings, then they should be replaced as chair of the student's APC at least until their return.

Course Requirements

(last modified May 2024)

The fundamentals of psychology are traditionally presented to students through formal courses of instruction. Education for graduate degrees is necessarily a compromise between achieving sufficient breadth of expertise so that the label of psychology has some meaning for all students and specializing appropriately to establish the highest level of competence in the chosen specialty. To aid in achieving acceptable breadth of education in psychology for all students, the following core course requirements are listed for each degree.

Thesis-Based Master's Degree Course Requirements

All students admitted to one of the doctoral programs without a master's degree shall complete the requirements for the thesis-based master's degree at Iowa State University. The Graduate College requires that 30 graduate credits be completed for this degree, of which at least 22 shall be earned at ISU.

The Department of Psychology requires successful completion of the course work specified in the student's Academic Plan developed with the student's Academic Plan Committee and approved by the department's Director of Graduate Education and the Graduate College. The Academic Plan shall include the following courses:

- 1) PSYCH 5010 (Foundations of Behavioral Research).
- 2) STAT 5101 (Statistical Methods for Data Analysis), or if appropriate, submit a request to the DOGE to take a different graduate level statistics course.
- 3) At least 3 hours of PSYCH 6990 (Research in Psychology) for work towards completion of the thesis.
- 4) 18 additional credits in psychology, including courses from at least 2 of the 5 groups listed below:
 - I. Biological Bases of Behavior (PSYCH 5190, NUTRS 5890)
 - II. Cognitive-Affective Bases of Behavior (PSYCH 5160)
 - III. Social Bases of Behavior (PSYCH 5800)
 - IV. Individual Behavior (PSYCH 5600, 6610)
 - V. Applied Psychology (PSYCH 5420, 6210, 5950B, 5950C, 5950E, 5950F, 5950J, 5950K,

In addition to the above coursework, an empirical thesis and a successful oral examination over this written product must be completed. PSYCH 6990 (Research) credit is earned during the undertaking of the thesis. More detail regarding these requirements is presented in the section entitled "RESEARCH TRAINING IN PSYCHOLOGY."

Doctoral Degree Course Requirements

The Graduate College requires that 72 graduate credits be completed for this degree, of which at least 36 shall be earned at ISU. All work must be completed within seven years. Students must complete the following courses:

- 1) PSYCH 5010 (Foundation of Behavioral Research).
- 2) All students must take STAT 5101 (Statistical Methods for Data Analysis), and either STAT 5212 (Experimental Design and Data Analysis) or STAT 5820 (Regression for Social and Behavioral Research); or if appropriate, submit a request to the DOGE to take a different graduate level statistics course.
- 3) At least 8 hours of PSYCH 6990 (Research in Psychology) for work towards completion of the Dissertation.
- 4) All students must take at least 1 course from 4 of the following 7 groups:
 - I. Biological Bases of Behavior (PSYCH 5190, NUTRS 5890)
 - II. Cognitive-Affective Bases of Behavior (PSYCH 5160)
 - III. Social Bases of Behavior (PSYCH 5800)
 - IV. Individual Behavior (PSYCH 5600, 6610)
 - V. Applied Psychology (PSYCH 5420, 6210, 5950B, 5950C, 5950E, 5950F, 5950J, 5950K, 5980G, HCI 5210)
 - VI. Historical and Philosophical Foundations (PSYCH 5050)
 - VII. Teaching of Psychology (PSYCH 6330*)

In addition to the above coursework, an empirical dissertation and a successful oral examination over this written product must be completed. Psychology 6990 (Research) credit is earned during the undertaking of the dissertation. More detail regarding these requirements is presented in the section entitled "RESEARCH TRAINING IN PSYCHOLOGY."

*All doctoral students will participate in mandatory Teaching Assistant (TA) training during departmental orientation, which is a prerequisite for being appointed to independent teaching assignments in the department when such opportunities exist. However, all doctoral students are encouraged to obtain additional training and experience in PSYCH 6330 (Teaching of Psychology).

Area Specific Requirements

Faculty in each of the specialty areas have also identified curricular requirements for students in their areas.

Additional Cognitive Area requirements:

Advanced Cognitive Psychology (5160): This will count as credit for the Cognitive-Affective Bases of Behavior core group.

Seminar in Cognitive Psychology (5980): A minimum of 4 sections of this course (1 for the master's and 3 additional for the doctorate) should be completed en route to the Ph.D degree. Students entering the program with a master's degree and for whom the APC determines that a transferring course is equivalent to 1 section of 5980 will complete a minimum of 3 sections of 5980.

Research Seminar: Cognitive (6920Q): Students will take 1 credit of 6920Q each semester, unless there is a conflict with another class. This requirement will be waived for students who have successfully completed the oral preliminary examination, have an approved dissertation proposal, and are not in residence on campus.

Additional Counseling Area requirements:

Refer to the materials provided by the Program Director during your first year.

Additional Social Area requirements:

Advanced Social Psychology (PSYCH 5800): This will count as credit for the Social Bases of Behavior core group.

Research Seminar: Social (PSYCH 6920R): Students must sign up for this course each semester until they have successfully defended their dissertation proposal. After that, registration in 6920R is optional, but attendance at colloquia is expected.

Seminar in Social Psychology (PSYCH 5950): All students must take at least one of the PSYCH 5950 sections prior to proposing to defend their dissertation proposal. Note that a 5950 course taken in fulfillment of core requirements cannot also be counted towards this requirement.

GRADUATE MINOR IN PSYCHOLOGY

(last modified April 2023)

The Psychology Graduate Minor at Iowa State University is available for master's and doctoral students seeking to integrate psychological science into their programs of study. A student may not minor and major in the same field.

Requirements for the Graduate Minor in Psychology:

- (a) Matriculated status in a master's or doctoral degree program at ISU.
- (b) Completion of 3 credits of graduate research methods with a grade of B or better: PSYCH 5010, RESEV 5540, HDFS 5030, or SOC 5110 (or if appropriate, submit a request to the DOGE to take a different graduate level research methods course).
- (c) Overall graduate cumulative GPA of 3.50 or better.

Required Courses: (12 Graduate Credits Required)

12 credits from at least 3 of the following 6 groups (I – VI); requests to substitute other psychology courses require approval from the Psychology DOGE:

- I. Biological Bases of Behavior (PSYCH 5190, NUTRS 5890)
- II. Cognitive-Affective Bases of Behavior (PSYCH 5160)
- III. Social Bases of Behavior (PSYCH 5800)
- IV. Individual Bases of Behavior (PSYCH 5600, 6610)
- V. Applied Psychology (PSYCH 5420, 6210, 5950B, 5950C, HCI 5210)
- VI. Historical and Philosophical Foundations (PSYCH 5050)

As per Graduate College requirements, Academic Plan Requirements for the Graduate Minor in Psychology Program:

- (a) A graduate faculty member from Psychology must serve on the student's Academic Plan Committee.
- (b) The major professor and the faculty member from Psychology may not be the same person.
- (c) The Graduate Minor in Psychology must be approved by the APC.
- (d) A Graduate Minor in Psychology cannot be added to a graduate degree that has already been received.
- (e) A Graduate Minor in Psychology cannot be added to an Academic Plan after the preliminary oral examination has been taken.
- (f) For a master's degree, the final oral examination must test for the Graduate Minor in Psychology. For a doctoral degree, the preliminary oral and final oral examinations must test for the Graduate Minor in Psychology.

CO-MAJOR IN PSYCHOLOGY

(last modified December 2010)

Individuals wishing to pursue a co-major in psychology in combination with another doctoral program at Iowa State

University should follow the process described below. This includes details related to the application process, coursework, and written and oral preliminary examinations. In all cases the student must conform to the guidelines laid out by the Graduate College regarding the completion of a co-major at the doctoral level.

Section 4.3.1 of the Graduate College Handbook:

A co-major is a program of study for a single degree in which the requirements for two separate majors are met. A single degree is granted when the student fulfills the requirements of both majors. The Academic Plan Committee will include co-major professors, each of whom represents one of the co-majors. Both co-major professors must be members of the graduate faculty. The same person, if a faculty member in both majors, will be allowed to serve as major professor for both majors. A preliminary oral examination and research work for the doctoral degree should be related to both majors. Students declaring co-majors must satisfy requirements established by each major as monitored by the representatives on the APC and the DOGEs of the two majors. A co-major cannot be added after the preliminary oral examination has been taken.

Application

Individuals wishing to pursue a co-major in Psychology will have been formally admitted within their primary department. Following this, the individual should complete a formal application to the doctoral program in Psychology. Details of the application process for the Department of Psychology can be found at <https://psychology.iastate.edu/graduate-study/graduate-admissions/>. Individuals should designate a co-major professor at the time of the application and should obtain a letter of endorsement from this faculty member indicating a willingness to serve as the co-major professor. The application deadline is December 1 for all three training areas.

Coursework and Program Area Affiliation

Students will complete the course requirements for the doctoral program in Psychology as defined in the graduate handbook. Quantitative methods courses (e.g., STAT 5101, STAT 5212) that are relevant to both majors may be counted as part of the hours needed for each major. Students may not double count other courses that are relevant to both the degree in Psychology and the primary major.

It is expected that students will affiliate with one of the areas of graduate study within the Department of Psychology. This would presumably be within the area where the co-major professor resides. The student must complete all area specific requirements including participation in weekly research seminars. Exceptions to the above expectations and requirements will be considered by the Graduate Program Committee (GPC) on a case-by-case basis.

Psychology co-majors who are admitted to work with faculty affiliated with the Counseling area will receive the Ph.D. in Psychology rather than in the specialty area **Counseling Psychology** (i.e., the training completed as part of the program will not lead to the student being license eligible upon graduation).

Written and Oral Preliminary Examinations

The student will complete a written qualifying examination and oral preliminary examination that includes content related to their program area of study in Psychology. It is expected that questions related to the co-major in Psychology will be integrated into the written qualifying exam administered by the primary co-major department, and that a minimum of two faculty in Psychology (one of whom is the co-major professor) will be asked to grade these questions. If the primary co-major department does not offer a written qualifying exam, the student will complete the qualifying exam associated with their program area of study in Psychology.

Co-Major Professor and Academic Plan Committee

The guidelines governing the selection of the co-major professor and the composition of the APC are defined by the Graduate College (<https://www.grad-college.iastate.edu/handbook/chapter.php?id=6>). The co-major professor should be a member of the Graduate Faculty in Psychology, unless the co-major professor has a faculty appointment in both the Department of Psychology and the primary co-major department.

CERTIFICATE IN QUANTITATIVE PSYCHOLOGY

(last modified May 2024)

Requirements for Admission to Certificate Program: 6 credits of graduate equivalent courses in statistics (STAT 5101 and either STAT 5212 or STAT 5820, or equivalent) plus 3 credits of graduate research methods in psychology (PSYCH 5010 or equivalent). Admission to the Certificate program requires a minimum grade of B+ in all three courses.

Required Courses: (13 graduate credits in addition to the above-mentioned courses, with a minimum of B- in each course)

A. Any three of the following courses (9 credits):

ECON 5000: Quantitative Methods in Economic Analysis 1
ECON 5100: Experimental Economics
ECON 5710: Intermediate Econometrics
HDFS 603: Advanced Quantitative Methods
PSYCH 5420: Applied Psychological Measurement
PSYCH 6050: Multilevel Modeling
RESEV 5540: Intermediate Research Methods
RESEV 5700: Surveys in Educational Research
STAT 5212: Experimental Design and Data Analysis (if not completed for the pre-requisite)
STAT 5215: Time Series Analysis
STAT 5279: Statistical Computing for Data Analysis
STAT 5730: Introduction to Survey Sampling
STAT 5750: Introduction to Multivariate Data Analysis
STAT 5770: Introduction to Categorical Data Analysis
STAT 5820: Regression for Social and Behavioral Research (if not completed for the pre-requisite)
STAT 5840: Computer Processing of Scientific Data
SOC 5120: Applied Multivariate Statistics for Social and Behavioral Sciences

B. Any four 1-credit sections of 5940 (4 credits)

PSYCH 5940A: Quantitative Behavioral Methods: Classical Psychometric Theory
PSYCH 5940B: Quantitative Behavioral Methods: Modern Psychometric Methods
PSYCH 5940C: Quantitative Behavioral Methods: Construct Validation
PSYCH 5940D: Quantitative Behavioral Methods: Multi-dimensional Scaling
PSYCH 5940E: Quantitative Behavioral Methods: Cluster Analysis
PSYCH 5940F: Quantitative Behavioral Methods: Meta-Analysis
PSYCH 5940G: Quantitative Behavioral Methods: Longitudinal Analysis
PSYCH 5940K: Quantitative Behavioral Methods: Mediation and Moderation
PSYCH 5940L: Quantitative Behavioral Methods: Missing Data
PSYCH 5940M: Quantitative Behavioral Methods: Power Analysis
PSYCH 5940N: Quantitative Behavioral Methods: Generalized Linear Models
PSYCH 5940P: Quantitative Behavioral Methods: Systematic Reviews
PSYCH 5940Q: Quantitative Behavioral Methods: Signal Detection
PSYCH 5940R: Quantitative Behavioral Methods: Practical Data Analysis

Note: Course equivalencies will be determined by the Director of the Certificate in Quantitative Psychology.

The Graduate College requires students to complete two Workday processes for a Certificate:

- a) create an Academic Plan for the proposed certificate, and
- b) apply for Program Completion of the certificate.

Non-Thesis Master's Degree Requirements*

*Note: The department does not accept applications for non-thesis master's degree.

On occasion, a student may opt to not complete the Ph.D. and to finish graduate studies with the master's degree. In these cases, the student must complete all the course requirements described above for the master's degree.

In consultation with their major professor, the student may elect to complete either an empirical thesis or a creative component. The creative component will be determined by the faculty mentor, guided by the student's and the mentor's interests, and approved by the student's Academic Plan Committee. In this case, the student must enroll in at least 3 credits of PSYCH 5990 (Creative Component) instead of PSYCH 6990 (Research). If the student changes to the non-thesis master's degree, this must be communicated to the Graduate College through a change in the Academic Plan.

RESEARCH TRAINING IN PSYCHOLOGY

In keeping with previously stated objectives, training in research methods and practice doing research should be an essential, integral part of doctoral education in Psychology. Students in doctoral programs are to be continuously involved in research. The program begins with research in the first year, through involvement in faculty research, continues with a required research thesis for the master's degree, and finishes with an original dissertation for the doctoral degree. In the first year, the emphasis should be on participation in the process of research rather than on a completed research project, although the latter is possible and desirable.

RESEARCH COMPLIANCE

At Iowa State University, all research is governed by rules established by the Office for Research Ethics. Any graduate student or undergraduate student involved in research with human subjects must complete an online training certification (CITI) prior to their involvement in such research. Students should provide documentation of their completion of this requirement to their major professor. Students should also retain a copy for themselves.

Any graduate student planning to conduct research with human subjects must first obtain the approval of the university's Institutional Review Board (IRB). Information concerning this process may be obtained by visiting this website: <https://compliance.iastate.edu/research-ethics-compliance/irb/about-the-irb/>. The Application for Approval of Research Involving Humans is available online through OneAegis IRB (see <https://compliance.iastate.edu/research-ethics-compliance/irb/submission-and-review/>).

THESIS AND DISSERTATION

Students should work closely with their major professor throughout the thesis and dissertation process. Students should communicate their intended topic and methodological approach to potential committee members prior to committee formation. Theses and dissertations must present empirical research, and they typically involve the collection of primary data. Other methodological approaches may be acceptable depending on committee input. All theses and dissertations must make a novel and substantive contribution to the psychological literature.

Students seeking the thesis-based master's degree should consult with their major professor to identify a topic for the thesis project. Students are expected to review the literature carefully in developing a research topic. The thesis should be original and creative, but the effort less in scope and/or magnitude than for a doctoral dissertation. The final document should be so thoroughly prepared that the paper may be publishable in a reputable psychology journal. It is expected that the level of supervision for a master's thesis by the major professor will be greater than for a doctoral dissertation.

After completion of the written qualifying examination and the oral preliminary examination (which constitutes the dissertation proposal meeting for students who clearly passed the written exam), the doctoral candidate will conduct an independent research project and write the doctoral dissertation.

For both the thesis and dissertation, a written proposal should be prepared for the Academic Plan Committee to evaluate. Committee members should be provided the document at least 14 calendar days prior to presentation and discussion of the research proposal (although lead times may vary by program). Recommendations and revisions offered by Committee members should be considered by the student and major professor, and no data

collection or analysis should occur prior to the Committee's approval of the proposal (except for pilot data that may be necessary or appropriate for justifying the proposed studies, or initial analyses of archival data). Following an approved proposal, students should collect and analyze data, and then complete a full written version of the thesis or dissertation document with feedback from their major professor. A final draft should be submitted to APC members at least 14 calendar days prior to the scheduled final oral examination.

Theses and dissertations should be prepared using [APA style](#), with tables and figures presented in-text rather than at the end of the document. The document may be prepared in a form suitable for publication (with appropriate appended material as the APC may request). Actual publication copies may be used, prepared, and presented in a form suitable to the Graduate College guidelines. Deadlines for thesis and dissertation submission can be found on the Graduate College website.

DOCTORAL PROGRAM ADMISSION AND CANDIDACY

Doctoral Student - Department Classification

Students previously admitted to the doctoral program will automatically be considered for continuation to doctoral studies upon completion of the thesis-based master's degree requirements. At that time, the student's master's degree Academic Plan Committee will evaluate the student's academic performance. They will prepare a recommendation regarding continuation to doctoral studies. The recommendation and supporting documentation will be summarized by the student's major professor on the Master's Academic Plan Committee Recommendation for Continuation to Doctoral Studies form. That report will be presented to the Department Chair and Graduate Faculty for consideration, with a formal vote on the recommendation occurring at the next scheduled faculty meeting.

Entry with a Master's Degree (last modified August 2013)

Students entering with a master's degree will be required to show evidence of a project comparable to a thesis in this department before they take the written qualifying examination or start work on their dissertation. Those students who enter the program with a completed thesis or research project from another university can submit that project for evaluation as a research equivalency project. Research equivalency will be evaluated by two faculty in the area into which the student was admitted and one faculty outside the area. Students and their major professor should request evaluation of the thesis for equivalency no later than the student's first semester on campus.

If a student enters the program without a thesis or research project or the student's previous thesis or research project was judged as not being comparable to theses in this department then they will need to complete an empirical thesis or a research equivalency project. This research equivalency project should be of similar standard to a manuscript intended for publication or a typical master's thesis in this department. The student will consult with the major professor to identify a suitable topic for research. The final document reporting the project must be evaluated by three faculty members (one should be outside of the student's primary field of emphasis). If any of the faculty members feels the document does not meet the standard, they will provide specific guidance for how to bring it up to standard. Upon completion of the equivalency project, the student's major professor will request continuation from the department faculty.

Note. Students with a previous master's degree who are required to complete another thesis project typically will be treated as first-year students for funding purposes. Students entering with a master's degree who receive credit for their master's thesis typically will be treated as second-year students for funding purposes. In either case, students who enter with a master's degree should complete their doctoral Academic Plan no later than the end of their 2nd year at ISU (preferably sooner).

Transferring Credit

Graduate College policy on transferring credit is that, at the discretion of the APC, and with the approval of the program and the Graduate College, graduate credits earned as a graduate student at another institution or through a distance education program offered by another institution may be transferred if the grade was B or better. Such courses must have been acceptable toward an advanced degree at that institution and must have been taught by individuals having graduate faculty status at that institution. If a student wishes to transfer credits from graduate courses taken at or through another university as an undergraduate student, it is that student's responsibility to provide verification by letter from that institution that those graduate courses were not taken to satisfy

undergraduate requirements for a degree. A transcript must accompany the Academic Plan in order to transfer credits. The APC may ask for other materials, such as a course outline or accreditation of the institution, to evaluate the course. Transfer courses not completed when the Academic Plan is submitted must be completed before the term in which the student graduates. A transcript must then be submitted for review and final approval.

Course equivalency

Once a student has been admitted to the Department of Psychology Graduate Program and has signed a Letter of Intent, the student may apply for credit in core group courses for classes completed at other institutions. Ideally, the process of determining course equivalencies should occur prior to the start of the Fall semester in which the student enters the program, with a focus on courses that would be taken in the first year being resolved by May 15. The student should submit the following to their major professor:

1. A written request for substitution of the class for a specific core course.
2. A transcript that includes the course with a grade of B or better.
3. Other materials relevant to the evaluation of the comparability of the class to the specific ISU Psychology core course, i.e., a syllabus that includes required readings and assignments, copies of papers and exams completed as part of the course.

In consultation with the DOGE, the major professor will choose an appropriate faculty member (usually the current or most recent instructor of the core course) to evaluate the comparability of the course to our core course and forward the written evaluation to the DOGE. In most cases, the person who teaches the course should do the evaluation. The DOGE will notify the student and the major professor of the outcome of the evaluation. If approved, the student will need to submit the memos (the one from the DOGE and the one from the major professor(s) who approved the equivalency) as well as a transcript from the institution(s) where they took the relevant courses along with their submission of their Academic Plan in Workday to make the credit official. If the APC approves the transfer of courses that are more than 11 years old, the Committee should examine the Graduate College guidelines for expired course credits to be included in an Academic Plan (see section 6.3.4 of the Graduate College Handbook).

Note. For a Ph.D., at least 36 credits must be earned at Iowa State University.

Doctoral Candidacy - Graduate College Classification

(last modified April 2022)

Doctoral candidacy is a status in the Graduate College that is conferred upon successful completion of the doctoral preliminary oral examination. The doctoral preliminary examination is composed of a written qualifying examination, prepared and administered by the department graduate faculty, and an oral preliminary examination. For students who earn a clear pass on the written qualifying exam, their dissertation proposal meeting can serve as their preliminary oral examination.

The Written Doctoral Qualifying Examination

(last modified January 2024)

Students in doctoral programs are required to take a written doctoral qualifying examination in one of the following areas: cognitive psychology, counseling psychology, or social psychology.

The written doctoral qualifying examination is intended to provide an opportunity for the consolidation and organization of knowledge gained in courses, readings, work experiences, and research. In the written examination, it is expected that the student will demonstrate appropriate knowledge of empirical information, theories, and issues in the selected area. The student is also expected to demonstrate critical thinking about research methods and interpretations in that area. Students are advised to consult with the members of the writing committee as soon as it is appointed, as noted below.

The written doctoral qualifying examination is normally taken immediately following completion of all doctoral degree course requirements. Exceptions will be evaluated by Area Directors in consultation with the major professor. Written qualifying examinations are given once each year, typically on the Thursday or Friday two weeks prior to the beginning of the fall semester. Students may consult with the DOGE regarding extenuating

circumstances. Students within the same area of specialization must take the exam on the same day at the scheduled time. In consultation with the major professor and area faculty, Area Directors will notify the DOGE of students who are prepared to complete the written doctoral qualifying examination by February 1st.

The written doctoral qualifying examinations are prepared and evaluated by three members of the department's graduate faculty. The ad hoc writing and evaluation committee is appointed by the DOGE in consultation with the relevant Area Director and with the consent of the members selected. Normally, the student's major professor is appointed to the ad hoc qualifying examination writing and evaluation committee. In the social and cognitive areas, a student's major professor will serve on the committee even if on a Faculty Professional Development Assignment. Ad hoc writing and evaluation committees should be formed and approved by the DOGE by March 1st.

Reading lists will be developed by the members of the ad hoc writing and evaluation committee and provided to students by May 1st. Sample items from prior written doctoral qualifying exams within each area will be made available to students who are completing the exam.

The examination is prepared to be up to eight hours in length. Exam questions must be prepared and delivered to the DOGE no later than 2 weeks prior to the examination. A written outline of a plausible answer to each question will be prepared by the writer at the time the examination is formulated. The writing committee must specify the weight for each question, and these weights must be identified on the examination, typically as the time allotted for the questions. Members of the writing committee may decide, at the time the examination is prepared, that respective grader's scoring of questions may be differentially weighted if that committee decides that such weights appropriately reflect differences in expertise among graders for evaluating a particular question.

Written doctoral qualifying examinations are administered by the DOGE. They are administered in two sessions beginning at 8:00 AM and 1:00 PM, with each session requiring up to 4 hours of writing. Examinations are physically administered by the Graduate Coordinator. When multiple students take the same exam, student's names do not appear on examination answers; each student is identified with a number. Every effort is made to permit each person to take their examination in a separate room, protected from normal disturbances.

When completing the exam, students will be provided with a departmental computer/laptop to type exam responses and a blank notepad to take notes. Students are not permitted to consult any sources while completing the exam (including study notes, external books/articles, other computers or electronic devices, internet sources, etc.). Students are also not permitted to bring personal items into the exam room, except for drinks, light snacks, or a jacket, if needed. Questions regarding these policies may be directed to the chair of the ad hoc writing and evaluation committee or the DOGE. Violation of these rules could result in failure of the exam.

Graduate students requesting accommodations are required to meet with staff in Student Accessibility Services (SAS) to establish eligibility. Once eligibility has been determined, SAS staff will coordinate with the DOGE to request appropriate accommodations for completion of the written doctoral qualifying examination.

If there are more than three faculty members on the ad hoc writing and evaluation committee, the grading may be divided, with the stipulation that at least three committee members grade each response. Regardless of committee size, the faculty grading a specific question will grade all responses to that question. Each written answer is independently evaluated by at least three members of the ad hoc writing and evaluation committee according to the weights specified previously. Each grader will assign a score between 1.0 and 5.0 to each answer. Each student's score on the entire qualifying exam will be the weighted numerical average of scores on individual questions. Each grader reports to the DOGE a score for each question to one decimal place. For each question, numerical values have the following definitions: 1 = poor; 2 = unsatisfactory; 3 = marginal; 4 = strong; 5 = outstanding. Upon completion of scoring and discussion (as necessary) for all students in each area by the ad hoc writing and evaluation committee, the DOGE will report the outcome to the chair of the student's APC and their major professor no later than ten class days following the examination. The DOGE will also report outcomes for all students taking the exam to the members of the ad hoc writing and evaluation committee. All outcome reports will include average scores on individual exam questions as well as weighted averages.

The following outcomes are possible:

- a) Exam score ≥ 3.5 - the student has clearly passed. The student is admitted to candidacy in the doctoral program and may continue with their dissertation proposal, which meets the Graduate College's oral preliminary exam requirement.

- b) $3.0 \leq \text{exam score} < 3.5$ – the student has conditionally passed. The student may only proceed to the oral preliminary exam after successfully completing additional follow-up activities. The ad hoc writing and evaluation committee, in consultation with the DOGE and the student's major professor, will determine the appropriate activities and will report the plan to the student within 30 days of grading the exam. Options are: 1) taking an oral examination over the written exam material, 2) taking an oral examination over the written exam material and completing additional remedial activities, or 3) retaking the same written examination, in whole or in part. All follow-up activities will be conducted and graded by the ad hoc writing and evaluation committee.
- c) Exam score < 3.0 - the student has failed the written qualifying examination. The ad hoc writing and evaluation committee, in consultation with the DOGE and the student's major professor, will determine the appropriate action and will report the plan to the student within 30 days of grading the exam. Options are to recommend that the student be terminated from the program or to allow the student to retake the same exam in its entirety or take a new exam when next offered.

The Doctoral Preliminary Oral Examination

(last modified April 2022)

The Graduate College requires that all students must complete a preliminary oral exam. In Psychology, graduate students who clearly pass the written qualifying exam may propose their dissertation as the preliminary oral exam.

The student must officially schedule the oral preliminary exam by completing the Graduate Request for Oral Exam in Workday. The student must have an approved doctoral Academic Plan prior to submitting this form. The request for a preliminary oral examination must be submitted to the Graduate College at least two weeks before the scheduled date and at least six months before the final oral examination (the dissertation defense).

The following conditions should be met before the Graduate Request for Oral Exam is submitted in Workday (from the Graduate College Handbook, section 4.4.2):

- admitted to full admission status in a Ph.D. granting program,
- Academic Plan approved no later than 3 months before the preliminary oral examination,
- English requirement met,
- not on probation with the Graduate College,
- time limit not exceeded (see Chapter 4 of the Graduate College Handbook)
- written qualifying examination passed, and
- registration for at least the equivalent of 2 credits (if a student is on an assistantship; 1 credit if not), or for Examination Only (GRST 6810B) if no course work is needed, during the term in which the preliminary oral examination is taken.

At least 14 days before the oral exam date, the student will distribute copies of the dissertation proposal to all members of the Academic Plan Committee. This oral exam fulfills the Graduate College requirements for the Oral Preliminary Exam.

General information:

The oral examination typically is two hours in duration, and all Academic Plan Committee members must be present. The student, in consultation with their major professor(s), may decide on the examination modality (in person, remote, or hybrid), and should discuss this choice of modality with the Committee. For remote or hybrid meetings, the student and major professor(s) must arrange for facilities and equipment to ensure full video and clear communication. If the chosen modality is not in person, the student must inform the Graduate College of the modality at the time the request form is submitted. Best practices for remote meetings may be found on the Graduate College website.

The content of the preliminary oral examination is not restricted to the subject of the written examination or the dissertation proposal. The oral examination is expected to test the student's breadth of knowledge in said area of specialization and supporting subjects, as well as their ability to critically evaluate issues and argue positions. The major professor's primary role is to facilitate the preliminary oral examination, ensuring that all committee members

are given adequate time for their questions.

Immediately following the preliminary oral examination, it is the responsibility of the APC to decide whether the student will be recommended for admission to candidacy and may continue to work toward the Ph.D. degree. Four options exist:

- The student passes and the APC recommends to the Graduate College that the student be admitted to candidacy.
- The student may continue their studies but must meet other conditions specified by the APC on the “Report of Preliminary Oral Examination” form under “Conditional Pass” before being recommended for admission to candidacy.
- The student fails but is given an opportunity to repeat the examination six months after the first attempt. An explanatory letter must accompany the report form.
- The student fails and is not permitted to continue to work toward a Ph.D. at ISU. An explanatory letter must accompany the report form.

In a preliminary oral examination, if one member of the Committee votes not to pass the candidate, the student passes, but each member of the Committee must forward to the Dean of the Graduate College in writing a justification for their vote. Upon request, these letters will be made available to the Committee at the time of the final oral examination. If more than one member of the Committee votes not to pass the student, the candidate does not pass the examination. An explanatory letter must accompany the report form.

Upon successful completion of the preliminary oral examination, the student is admitted to candidacy for the Ph.D. degree. If the graduate student fails the oral examination, the student may be allowed to retake it. Six months must elapse between the first attempt and the next. The entire APC must be convened for the preliminary oral examination. The preliminary oral examination must be passed at least six months prior to the final oral examination. An exception to the rule is allowed if a request, signed by the student, the major professor, the entire Academic Plan Committee, and the program’s DOGE is approved by the Dean of the Graduate College.

STUDENT PROGRESS AND EVALUATION

Expected Timeline for Department of Psychology Graduate Students

(last modified November 2018)

This is a brief overview of the expected timeline for major milestones in a 5-year Ph.D. program, presented separately for students entering with and without a Master’s Degree in Psychology, or related field. Completion of these milestones will vary across programs and students. In addition, students must progress toward completion of degree course requirements. This schedule does not include a timetable for completion of additional certificates or minors in other fields, or completion of research products such as journal publications. The specific steps and requirements for each of these milestones are described in the Graduate Education in Psychology Handbook.

Students entering without master’s degree		Students entering with master’s degree	
Year 1	• Onboarding meeting with major professor • Approved Master’s Academic Plan • Conduct research in major professor’s lab • Propose thesis	Obtain decision regarding thesis equivalency (fall semester)	
		Yes, thesis is equivalent to ISU thesis	Non-thesis M.S. or thesis is not equivalent to ISU thesis
Year 2	• Defend thesis	• Onboarding meeting with major professor • Conduct research in major professor’s lab	• Onboarding meeting with major professor • Conduct research in major professor’s lab • Develop equivalency project with major professor
		• Approved Doctoral Academic Plan • Pass written qualifying exam by end of August	• Complete equivalency project and obtain approval from three faculty
Year 3	• Approved Doctoral Academic	• Pass oral preliminary	• Approved Doctoral Academic

	Plan • Pass written qualifying exam by end of August	exam • Propose dissertation	Plan • Pass written qualifying exam by end of August
Year 4	• Pass oral preliminary exam • Propose dissertation	• Defend dissertation	• Pass oral preliminary exam • Propose dissertation
Year 5	• Defend dissertation		• Defend dissertation

Annual Student Performance Evaluation

To ensure consistent and timely progress through the graduate program, students are evaluated periodically in terms of their performance and accomplishments. The philosophy regarding such evaluations is based on an interactive model. That is, there is an on-going communication between student and faculty (Academic Plan Committee and Graduate Faculty). Inherent in this model is the assumption that there is mutual input and involvement of student and faculty in the evaluation process. As a result, a student should be fully informed of any evaluative information. These evaluations are meant to allow both the faculty and student to assess and acknowledge performance in terms of quality and progress. Clear indications of excellence or deficiency need to be noted. Ideally, evaluations should provide students with an informed commentary on their progress allowing students to optimize their approach to graduate education.

Students who change advisors in the middle of the academic year should meet with both the former advisor and the new advisor with respect to their annual performance evaluation. The new advisor is responsible for signing and submitting the annual evaluation form. Students who are co-advised should similarly meet with both advisors (regardless of their program affiliations) during the annual performance evaluation. The primary advisor is responsible for signing and submitting the annual evaluation form.

Procedure for Department of Psychology Annual Performance Evaluation

◆ **By First Monday in April:** In preparation for the spring review, the student and major professor will meet for final review and discussion of performance and progress toward goals. Written evaluation, comments, and signatures are provided on the statement form.

The student and the major professor will complete the "Annual Spring Review Summary Report" that will serve as the primary report for the spring review of students' performances. This report will include relevant background information, a chronological record of graduate study "milestones," a listing of core courses completed and grades earned, core course GPA, cumulative GPA, a summary of research activity, a summary of fellowship or grant applications/awards, a summary of teaching experiences, a summary of practica and other professional experience, a summary of service activities, and summary comments from the major professor highlighting accomplishments and noting deficiencies or areas needing improvement. Finally, a recommendation regarding the student's continuance in the program will be made. Possible recommendations include continuation, conditional continuation, probation, and dismissal. Once the form has been completed, the student and major professor will meet to discuss the student's annual review, their professional goals and development plan, as well as the mentor-mentee relationship. Both the major professor and the student will then sign the form, indicating that they have reviewed and discussed the information. The electronic form and a hard copy of the signed form must be returned to the Graduate Coordinator by April 15. If a student believes that important information has been omitted or is incorrect even after discussion with the major professor, the student may submit a supplementary written report to the DOGE by the Monday of prep week.

◆ **By Third Monday in April:** All summary reports for students will be delivered to the DOGE as a single file and sent to all faculty members before the Spring Review (see below). Faculty are asked to review the reports prior to the review meeting.

Note: At any time during the academic year, any faculty member may provide feedback or concern relevant to a student's performance and progress directly to a student and the student's major professor. This information will be addressed in the discussions between student and major professor as outlined above and as needed.

The DOGE will use the information provided in the forms to flag students who have not met benchmarks or whose faculty advisor has expressed concerns about their progress. For 2nd year students and beyond who have not met

benchmarks or for whom there are concerns, the Graduate Program Committee (GPC) will meet with each student's major professor before the faculty meeting to formulate a recommendation that is presented as part of the discussion of the student's case. Input is also solicited from course instructors and assistantship supervisors. The purpose of these meetings is to simplify the faculty review meeting by thoroughly discussing options and recommendations prior to the full faculty review.

◆ **Spring Review—Following Finals Week:** At each spring review, 2nd year students and beyond who are progressing well through the program and whose continuation is not in question will be only briefly discussed prior to a faculty vote for continuation. The GPC will present recommendations for students who have not met benchmarks or whose continuation is in question based on deliberations conducted with the major professor. The DOGE will provide a chart of cases with information on the benchmark, mitigating factors, and recommendations. Past cases will be included to promote consistency. If the recommendation does not receive majority support, a new recommendation will be entertained and voted on.

First year students will be discussed individually to make sure they are making good progress and to introduce them to faculty members who have not met them yet.

Within one week of the review, the major professor will forward to the student a written report of the faculty's action and qualitative feedback. Copies of this letter must also be sent to the Graduate Coordinator for student records. In cases of negative actions (conditional continuation, probation, or dismissal), the student also will receive a letter from the DOGE confirming the action of the faculty and specifying the reasons for dismissal or the following information about deficiencies resulting in conditional continuation or probation.

- 1) The nature of the deficiency as perceived by the faculty.
- 2) What actions are needed to rectify the deficiency.
- 3) The deadline for rectifying the deficiency.
- 4) The penalty for failing to meet the stated criteria.

In cases of students whose performance is judged to be substandard, the recommendation is generally that the student's status in the program be terminated.

New graduate students whose GPAs fall below 3.0 at the end of the first semester will be given a one term grace period to bring grades back to a 3.0 GPA. These students will receive a warning letter from the Graduate College but will not be immediately placed on probation by the Graduate College.

Minimum Timeline for Graduate Student Annual Review Evaluation

(last modified November 2018)

Listed below are minimum criteria for progress through the graduate program, presented separately for students entering with and without a Master's Degree in Psychology, or related field. These are **minimum** criteria for a positive evaluation during the spring review. They do not represent the ideal or preferred timeline for progress through the program. Ideally, students will complete the program in 5 years (not counting the predoctoral internship for Counseling students), which means that these milestones would be met earlier than the minimum timeline (please refer to "expected timeline"). In addition, students must progress toward completion of degree course requirements with a minimum GPA of 3.0 as required by the Graduate College.

Meeting these minimum criteria does not automatically result in a student's continuation in the program. Negative outcomes (conditional continuation, probation, or dismissal) may be due to other deficiencies (e.g., not developing as an independent scholar, not fulfilling lab responsibilities, etc.). Thus, these minimum criteria are not the sole basis of students' annual reviews.

Students entering without master's degree		Students entering with master's degree	
Year 1	- Onboarding meeting with major professor - Approved Master's Academic Plan	Obtain decision regarding thesis equivalency	
		Yes, thesis is equivalent to ISU thesis	Non-thesis M.S. or thesis is not equivalent to ISU thesis

	• Conduct research in major professor's lab	• Onboarding meeting with major professor • Conduct research in major professor's lab	• Onboarding meeting with major professor • Conduct research in major professor's lab
Year 2	• Propose thesis	• Approved Doctoral Academic Plan	• Develop equivalency project with major professor
Year 3	• Defend thesis	• Pass written qualifying exam by end of August	• Complete equivalency project and obtain approval from three faculty • Approved Doctoral Academic Plan
Year 4	• Approved Doctoral Academic Plan • Pass written qualifying exam by end of August	• Pass oral preliminary exam • Propose dissertation	• Pass written qualifying exam by end of August
Year 5	• Pass oral preliminary exam • Propose dissertation	• Defend dissertation	• Pass oral preliminary exam • Propose dissertation
Year 6	• Defend dissertation		• Defend dissertation

Appeal of Recommendation

Any student has the right to a view contrary to the Graduate Faculty's recommendation and to due process in consideration of that view. A student may request a reconsideration of a dismissal, probation, or conditional continuation. An appeal of the spring review decision must address issues raised in the report of results by the major professor (see previous section). This report along with the student's written comments and relevant information should be submitted to the Department Chair and to the student's APC. The Department Chair will charge the student's committee with the task of investigation and reconsideration of the decision in light of the student's comments. If the student and/or the Department Chair feel that the student's Academic Plan Committee cannot handle the appeal impartially, the Department Chair will appoint an ad hoc committee of not less than three graduate faculty members to reconsider the case.

Following a reasonable period of time for investigation and reconsideration, which should not exceed two weeks, the review committee (either Academic Plan Committee or ad hoc) must present the student's request with the investigation results to the Department Chair and Graduate Faculty with a recommendation for a specific decision for action. The student must be informed in writing within 48 hours of the resulting decision with explanation for the basis of that decision made by the faculty.

Grievances

If a graduate student believes they have been treated unfairly or unprofessionally or that their scholarly or professional competence has not been evaluated fairly, a grievance may be filed through the procedures outlined in the Graduate College's grievance policy (Chapter 9 of the Graduate College Handbook). First, the student should discuss the complaint with the person or persons most directly involved in the matter: a faculty member, major professor, Academic Plan Committee, Director of Graduate Education (DOGE), or Department Chair. If these discussions are unsuccessful and further adjudication is desired, the student may submit the grievance, which must be in writing, to the department's grievance committee. The committee should respond in writing within twelve class days following the Graduate College's policies. A graduate student unsatisfied with the department's action may appeal in writing to the Dean of the Graduate College within 14 days of the department's decision. A new grievance appeal committee following the Graduate College's policies will submit its recommendation regarding the appeal to the Dean of the Graduate College for action. Graduate student(s) still unsatisfied with the disposition of the grievance—on matters of procedure only—may appeal in writing to the Provost and, if necessary, to the President of the University.

Checklist and Timetable

Below is a timetable and checklist outlining some of the major events a full-time student in a doctoral program will

encounter while progressing through the graduate program. The timetable is meant as a general reference in that students' progress may be different depending upon the program they are in and the specific needs and abilities they have. Students who wish further information concerning their particular program should consult with faculty members of that program. Students should keep in mind the timetable described in the Minimum Criteria table above.

The [Workday forms](#) listed in this section are described on the Graduate College website. [Important deadlines](#) can also be found on the Graduate College website.

Orientation (First Year, 1st Semester)

- ✓ Make faculty contacts
 - Become acquainted with major professor(s)
 - Start thinking about a thesis topic
- ✓ Complete onboarding meeting with major professor within the first 5 weeks of the fall semester
 - Submit meeting notes to the Graduate Coordinator and DOGE
- ✓ Take Graduate English Exam (non-native speakers of English, only)
 - You will receive information about this during 1st semester
- ✓ Transfer medical history
 - Have it sent to the Student Health Center before you get sick

Master's Academic Plan Committee and Academic Plan (First Year)

- ✓ Create a [Master's Academic Plan Committee](#) in Workday in consultation with your major professor
 - Select at least 3 members - minimum requirements:
 - Major professor
 - Professor from area of specialization
 - Professor from outside one's area of specialization
 - Professor from minor department (if applicable)
- ✓ Complete [Master's Academic Plan](#) in Workday
 - Ensure that you have included at least 30 credit hours for the master's, and that you have consulted the *Graduate Education in Psychology Handbook* for required courses
 - Submit the form in Workday, and it will be routed to the faculty, DOGE, and Graduate College
- ✓ [Changes to the Committee](#) can be made later

Thesis Proposal

- ✓ Complete proposal draft of thesis and receive approval from your major professor to circulate to the Academic Plan Committee
- ✓ Plan committee meeting at least 3 weeks before intended meeting
 - Schedule a meeting time and reserve a room with the Graduate Coordinator; notify committee members
 - Send proposal to committee members at least 14 days before meeting

Filing for Degree Completion

- ✓ Complete the [Apply for Program Completion \(Graduation\)](#) form in Workday; please review and complete this application by [Graduate College deadlines](#)

Thesis Defense

- ✓ Complete draft of thesis and receive approval from major professor prior to circulating to your committee
- ✓ Plan committee meeting at least 3 weeks before intended meeting
 - Schedule a meeting time and reserve room with the Graduate Coordinator; notify members
 - Send proposal to committee members at least 10 days before meeting
- ✓ Submit [Request for Final Examination Form](#) in Workday at least 3 weeks before defense meeting
- ✓ Immediately following the defense, the faculty advisor should [Submit Results of the Oral Exam](#) in Workday
- ✓ After committee approval of the thesis, submit [Graduate Student Approval Form](#) in Workday by the required deadline
- ✓ [Consult the Graduate College website](#) to format and submit your final thesis by the final due date
- ✓ Continuation recommended to full faculty by Academic Plan Committee (major professor submits the departmental continuation form to DOGE for faculty approval)

Doctoral Academic Plan Committee and Academic Plan

- ✓ Create a [Doctoral Academic Plan Committee](#) in Workday in consultation with your major professor
 - Select at least 5 members - minimum requirements:
 - Major professor
 - Professor from outside one's area of specialization
 - Professor from minor department (if applicable)
- ✓ Complete [Doctoral Academic Plan](#) in Workday
 - This must be approved by the Graduate College at least 3 months prior to the Oral Preliminary Exam (Dissertation Proposal)
 - Ensure that you have included at least 72 credit hours for the doctorate, and that you have consulted the *Graduate Education in Psychology Handbook* for required courses
 - Submit electronically for signatures by committee and DOGE before approval by Graduate College

Written Qualifying Examination (after completion of all doctoral degree course requirements; typically, after Third Year or later)

- ✓ You should have completed both the Doctoral Academic Plan Committee and Doctoral Academic Plan forms in Workday
- ✓ By February 1st, speak with your major professor regarding your intent to complete the written qualifying exam in August; they will notify the Area Director and DOGE of your intent to take the exam

Oral Preliminary Examination/Dissertation Proposal

For students who earned a clear pass (a score of 3.5 or higher) on the written qualifying exam, the oral preliminary exam may consist of the dissertation proposal meeting.

- ✓ You must have passed your written qualifying exam prior to the oral preliminary exam
- ✓ Plan a committee meeting
 - Schedule a meeting time and reserve room with the Graduate Coordinator; notify members
 - Complete [Preliminary Oral Exam Request form](#) in Workday at least 2 weeks before oral exam and at least 6 months before the final oral exam (dissertation defense). Please note that your Doctoral Academic Plan must have been completed 3 months before this request is submitted
 - Send materials to committee members at least 14 days before meeting
- ✓ Immediately following the preliminary exam, the faculty advisor should [Submit Results of the Oral Exam](#) in Workday

Preparing for Graduation/Defense of the Doctoral Degree (Final Semester)

- ✓ [Apply for Program Completion \(Graduation\)](#) in Workday; please review and complete this application by [Graduate College deadlines](#)
 - Think about whether you will be attending commencement
 - Will your major professor be presenting you?
- ✓ Note [Graduate College deadlines](#) for the defense and the submission of the dissertation
- ✓ If you will not graduate this semester after all, withdraw the application and resubmit the semester of graduation

Dissertation Defense (Final Semester)

- ✓ Complete draft of dissertation and receive approval from your major professor to proceed to the defense
- ✓ Plan committee meeting at least 4 weeks before intended date
 - Schedule a meeting time and reserve room with the Graduate Coordinator; notify members
 - Submit [Request for Final Oral Examination form](#) on Workday to Graduate College at least 3 weeks before defense meeting
 - Send your dissertation to committee members at least 14 days before meeting
- ✓ Immediately following the defense, the faculty advisor should [Submit Results of the Oral Exam](#) in Workday
- ✓ After committee approval of the dissertation,
 - [Consult the Graduate College website](#) to ensure your dissertation is formatted appropriately, and submit final dissertation to Graduate College by the due date
 - Complete the [Graduate Student Approval Form](#) in Workday by the required deadline

GRADUATE ASSISTANTSHIPS, REGISTRATION, AND TUITION SCHOLARSHIPS

Graduate Assistantship and Other Funding Criteria

(last modified September 2015)

Eligibility criteria for graduate assistantships are listed below:

1. First year students seeking the Ph.D. in Psychology are generally funded by the department. **Only** students on Psychology department assistantships or fellowships will be provided space in the department or have access to other departmental resources (i.e., printing, computer lab).
2. To be eligible for funding for their second academic year (third academic semester), first-year students must have an established Academic Planning Committee and approved Academic Plan by the end of their first academic year (second academic semester).
3. To be eligible for funding fall semester of their third year (fifth academic semester), students must have an approved thesis proposal by the end of their second academic year (fourth academic semester).
 - ✓ To be eligible for funding during their fourth academic year (seventh and eighth semesters), students must successfully defend their thesis by the end of their third academic year (sixth academic semester).
5. To be eligible for priority funding beyond their fourth year, students must have successfully passed their preliminary oral examination. Students beyond their fourth year receive lower priority in funding than students in their first 4 years.
6. Students entering with a master's degree are treated as one year ahead of their entering date for funding decisions.
7. Departmental funding of students not meeting the above criteria would require approval of the Graduate Program Committee and Department Chair.
8. In the interest of consistency and equity, and as a courtesy to the department, faculty wishing to support an ineligible student with grant money should submit a brief memo to the Graduate Program Committee and Department Chair outlining the necessity for this action.

Graduate Assistantship Benefits

Health Insurance Plan – Graduate assistants (GA) with an appointment of one quarter time or more receive single health insurance coverage as a benefit of employment, **enrollment in the health insurance plan is automatic** and the cost is paid for by your department.

Dental Insurance Plan – Graduate assistants with an appointment of one quarter time or more are eligible for the dental insurance plan which is partially subsidized by the university and the employee premium will be deducted from the GA's paycheck. Enrollment can be done on Workday during open enrollment or by submitting a paper enrollment form at other times of the year.

Dependents – Graduate assistants may also enroll their lawful spouse or domestic partner, and unmarried dependent children under age 26. A portion of the monthly premium will be deducted from the GA's paycheck when adding coverage for dependents. An enrollment form on Workday must be completed. Dependents must be added within 30 days of your hire date or with a qualifying event. *Note:* Once you and your dependents are added to the plan, you will be required to remain on the plan until the end of the policy year or until your assistantship ends.

For plan specifics, costs, open enrollment dates, and benefit details for the health and dental insurance plans, please see the University Human Resource, Student and Scholar Health Insurance Program website at: <https://sship.hr.iastate.edu>

Vacation - The vacation policy for GAs is the same as that of B-base faculty, i.e., GAs **do not** accrue vacation time. For both fall and spring semester, they are required to be on duty two days prior to the start of the semester through the end of finals week with the following exceptions: fall break and spring break. GAs who are employed for the summer session are expected to be on duty one day prior to the start of the session through the day on which

the session ends (or until grades are due if the GA is an instructor). All ISU employees, regardless of appointment base, are **not** required to be on duty during official university holidays (New Year's Day, Memorial Day, Independence Day, Labor Day, Thanksgiving Day, the Friday after Thanksgiving, Christmas, and two additional days each year determined by the president and the administrative board). Any additional vacation must be negotiated with the supervisor(s) to whom a GA is assigned.

Leave of Absence for Graduate Students

Although the department generally encourages continuous study until completion of degree objectives, some students may require a leave of absence due to a variety of personal, medical, and/or professional reasons. Leaves of absence for up to two years duration may be requested in a joint memo from the student and the major professor to the chairperson of the GPC. This memo should clearly specify the beginning and ending dates of the requested leave of absence, as well as the reasons for the request. The GPC will consider the request at its next regularly scheduled meeting or in an emergency session, if necessary.

Except in cases with extraordinary personal or medical justification, leaves of absence will take effect at the beginning of the next academic semester. Absences extending beyond two years or the agreed upon ending date, whichever occurs first, will necessitate a reapplication for admission to graduate study in the Department of Psychology. Of course, assistantships cannot be guaranteed upon return from a leave of absence. Students on internship are considered to be full-time students and are not required to petition for a leave of absence to cover the period of their internship.

Students who have met all requirements for the Ph.D. degree except for the dissertation before leaving the department, usually for employment, are automatically placed on an in-absentia status without a formal petition to the GPC. These students are reviewed each spring as part of the annual review of graduate students, at which time the faculty votes for continuation, conditional continuation, probation, or dismissal. As a rule, students will be placed on conditional continuation or probation at the end of their second year in absence with the stipulation that their dissertation must be successfully defended within a specified period of time, usually one year. Students not meeting these conditions may be dismissed.

Short-Term Absence

(last modified October 2022)

If you temporarily cannot perform your assistantship duties (e.g., travel or short-term illness):

- Research, clinical, or administrative duties: Contact the supervisor of your research, administrative, or clinical assignment to make appropriate arrangements for filling in, performing the work remotely, and/or making up the work at a later time.
- For teaching assistantships that primarily involve course management (e.g., grading papers): Contact the instructor of record to make appropriate arrangements for filling in, completing the work remotely, and/or making up the work at a later time.
- For teaching assistantships that involve course instruction (e.g., teaching a discussion section within a larger course, or teaching as the instructor of record): Contact the instructor of record or the Associate Chair (if you are the instructor of record) as well as the DOGE to determine the appropriate action. Possible actions may be to teach the class remotely, ask another instructor to cover the class, present a previously recorded lecture, engage students in another activity/assignment (e.g., a low-stakes assignment, an online learning activity, or extra group work), or cancel the class period. Do not cancel the class period without first contacting the instructor of record or Associate Chair.
- If the instructor of record or Associate Chair determines that the class period must be canceled, send an announcement to your class and contact the main office staff (in case students contact them with questions).
- Work with the instructor of record or Associate Chair to find a replacement for subsequent classes if you or another instructor are not able to provide in-class lecture or activities.

Graduate Assistantship Tuition Scholarships

Graduate students appointed to graduate assistantships 1/4-time or more (except those also holding traineeships, fellowships, or contracts that provide funds for payment of tuition and/or fees), are assessed tuition at the full resident (in-state) rate. The Graduate Assistantship tuition scholarships are not paid directly to the student but are applied to the student's tuition bill. For Ph.D. students on a 1/2-time appointment, the benefit is 100%.

For fall and spring semesters, a student must be on appointment for at least three months during the semester to qualify for a Graduate Assistantship tuition scholarship. For summer session, a student must be on appointment for at least six weeks during the term to qualify for a Graduate Assistantship Tuition Scholarship. For all terms, appointments must have been processed by the Graduate College before the end of the first full month of classes (i.e., usually around the fifth week of the fall or spring semesters). Graduate Assistantship tuition scholarships not used by the due date of the second fee payment installment will be forfeited.

Students who will not be on appointment for the summer session may still be eligible for the Graduate Assistantship tuition rate. This tuition rate is restricted to a summer session following a nine-month appointment. No action is required to receive the resident tuition rate in the summer for students who held assistantships the prior fall and spring terms.

Graduate Student Awards

(last modified January 2024)

The guidelines and nomination forms for University Awards can be found at: <http://www.grad-college.iastate.edu/academics/awards/>.

University Research Excellence Awards

The purpose of these awards is to recognize graduate students for outstanding research or creativity as documented in their theses and dissertations. These students are also expected to be academically superior and able to not only do research but develop a well-written product. The intent of this program is to recognize up to 10% of graduating students who have submitted theses and dissertations. The Research Excellence Program is administered by the Graduate College with additional support from the Graduate and Professional Student Senate. The process of selection will be the responsibility of each department or interdepartmental program. Awards are offered each semester and summer session. Note: Students must be enrolled in the semester in which they are nominated; graduated students are not eligible.

Each Research Excellence Award consists of a letter of commendation from the ISU President and a certificate of achievement signed by the Graduate Dean and the ISU President. Recipients are recognized at Commencement – each is given an honor cord, cited in the ISU Commencement Program and recognized during the ceremony; the award is also noted on the student's transcript. Each term a formal photograph is taken of recipients with the ISU President, the Provost, and/or the Graduate Dean. Funding is not available through this program to offer cash prizes. Departments, however, are encouraged to use their own funds for this purpose whenever possible. Any cash prize should be handled directly by the department.

Students may self-nominate for this award in a letter addressed to the Graduate Program Committee (c/o the DOGE). This letter should describe the student's research achievements and must include the student's curriculum vitae (CV).

University Teaching Excellence Awards

The purpose of these awards is to recognize and encourage outstanding achievement by graduate students in teaching. The program is administered by the Graduate College with additional support from the Graduate and Professional Student Senate, and awards are offered each semester. The process of selection will be the responsibility of each department or interdepartmental program. In cases where departments hire students from other departments to teach courses for them, the hiring or employing department is responsible for recommending these students for awards (i.e. the department that organizes and supervises the courses to be taught).

Each Teaching Excellence Award consists of a letter of commendation from the ISU President and a certificate of achievement signed by the ISU President and the Graduate Dean. Probably many teaching excellence winners will not be graduating at the time these awards are given, but recipients will also be recognized at the time of their graduation – each will be given an honor cord, cited in the ISU Commencement Program and recognized during the ceremony; the award is also noted on the student's transcript. At the end of each term a formal photograph is taken of recipients with the ISU President, the Provost and/or the Graduate Dean. Funding is not available through this program to offer cash prizes. Departments, however, are encouraged to use their own funds for this purpose whenever possible. Any cash prize should be handled directly by the department.

Any graduate student with teaching responsibilities, and who has been on a teaching appointment for at least two terms (including summer sessions), is eligible for an award. Nominees do not necessarily need to be on a C-base appointment but must be at ISU primarily to work on a graduate degree. Recipients of these awards must be enrolled at ISU at the time the awards are given; students who have already graduated are not eligible. A student is eligible for only one Teaching Excellence Award; however, it is possible to grant a student both a Teaching and a Research Excellence Award during their academic career. Examples of teaching duties include:

1. serving as the sole instructor for one or more sections of a course.
2. making frequent classroom presentations while not solely responsible for the instruction.
3. serving as discussion leader for a recitation section.
4. serving as laboratory instructor presenting new material or experiments not covered in the lecture section.
5. serving as laboratory instructor reviewing homework assignments and/or answering questions.
6. assisting with setting up experiments, preparing and/or cleaning up before and after class or lab.
7. tutoring students or staffing a help room and/or assisting students in a lab.
8. proctoring exams, grading homework and/or lab reports; working on course web pages, or projects.
9. performing other teaching-related duties unique to the department.

It is expected that those nominated for an award would be involved primarily with teaching duties like those described in items 1-5, although additional involvement in items 6-9 is possible. Students may self-nominate for this award in a letter addressed to the GPC (c/o the DOGE). This letter should describe the courses taught, the student evaluations received by the nominee, and other evidence of course and teaching quality.

Awards will be given at the end of each term. It is anticipated that many nominees will not be graduating at the time these awards are given. In these cases, the award will be given now, and the student also recognized later at graduation.

The DOGE will request nominations for the University Research Excellence and Teaching Excellence awards in October (for Fall awards) and March (for Spring awards) each year. No awards will be given during summer terms.

Department of Psychology Research Enhancement Awards

The purpose of these awards is to support highly creative and important research projects of graduate students that (1) are very likely to make important contributions to the literature through publication in top-tier journals, thereby advancing the national visibility of the student and the department, and (2) cannot be completed without additional funding because of its cost. The total number of awards given will vary from year to year because it is dependent on the department's budget. Approximately 1-2 \$500 awards should be available each year.

As indicated in Criterion 1, the intent of these awards is to encourage and support high quality research that results in publications in top-tier journals that are first or sole-authored by graduate students. Thus, successful applicants typically will propose a strong non-thesis or non-dissertation study, or an outstanding thesis or dissertation study that clearly exceeds expectations for this academic requirement. In addition, an applicant's track record, projected timetable for completion, and other assurances will convince evaluators of the high probability that the study will be followed through to publication in a major journal.

Criterion 2 reflects financial need. This means that students must have expenses above and beyond their own contributions and funds they have obtained from other internal/external sources. This criterion also would generally disqualify students who propose a study that clearly is part of a larger, externally funded research project.

Students may self-nominate for this award by submitting their proposal (up to 1300 words) to the chair of the

Research Committee electronically. The narrative proposal should address the following points: purpose and objectives of the study, design and methods of study, and target journal for publication. Two attachments should be enclosed with the proposal: 1) a project budget estimating all costs and 2) a timetable for completion and publication of the study. Submission deadline is **March 1st**.

Department of Psychology Graduate Student Excellence Awards

We believe that it is important to recognize graduate student excellence. The number of awards per year may vary (i.e., some years there may be no awards given, others more than one may be given). The award will include an honorarium in the amount of \$100. Nominations are due to the Graduate Program Committee by **March 15**. Students may self-nominate for these awards by providing a brief letter (1 page maximum) to the chair of the GPC indicating why they should receive the award. Awards will be announced on or about April 15th. An individual cannot receive more than one award per year.

The purpose of the award is to recognize outstanding contributions of graduate students. They can be but are not limited to:

Exceptional Departmental Service
Exceptional Teaching in a Large/Small Enrollment Course
Exceptional Undergraduate Mentoring
Outstanding Conceptual/Empirical Journal Article (submit manuscript along with nomination)
Exceptional Research Productivity (submit student's CV along with nomination letter)

To be eligible for one of the Outstanding Conceptual/Empirical Journal Article awards the student must have published a sole or first-authored manuscript in a major journal. The manuscript must be accepted in the 12 months prior to the award being given. A manuscript may be nominated only once for this award.

For teaching-related awards, the nomination letter should include information about the courses taught, the student evaluations received, and other evidence of course quality (see information about the Graduate College Teaching Excellence awards above).

Department of Psychology Travel Funding

The department offers up to \$400 for graduate student conference travel, with a maximum frequency of once per fiscal year. The student must be in years 1-6 of the Psychology Graduate Program and in good standing. The student also must be either 1st author or the presenter of the research. Funding may not be granted when the research being reported is part of a large external grant, or when the faculty supervisor of the research has incentive funds from a current or recent grant related to the research. The student must also request travel support from other relevant university sources, such as Professional Advancement Grants (PAG) from the Graduate and Professional Student Senate (GPSS). PAG applications are due by the 15th of the month prior to travel but are also accepted earlier.

To apply for department funding, students must complete the supplemental travel request form (available on Canvas or in the Psychology Department main office) prior to travel. It is recommended that students submit the form at least 30 days prior to travel. Reimbursement will occur after travel. Receipts are required for reimbursement. Submit receipts along with a note about the amount funded by the department to ISU Finance Delivery (finance_delivery@iastate.edu; Worktag available by contacting the main office).

Availability and amount of funding depends on the department budget as well as the number of requests made each year. Summer funding requests made by students who are graduating or leaving for internship that summer are less likely to be funded. Requests for summer travel funding should be made by June 30th. Questions about eligibility should be directed to the Department Chair.

David Campbell/Fred Borgen Psychology Graduate Student International Travel Fund

The Campbell/Borgen Psychology Graduate Student International Travel Fund has been established in recognition of Dr. Campbell's gratitude for the excellent graduate education that he received from the faculty of the Iowa State University Department of Psychology. Through this fund the Donor would also like to recognize the contributions of

Dr. Fred Borgen, a faculty member for 32 years in the Iowa State University Department of Psychology and former student of the Donor at the University of Minnesota.

The Campbell/Borgen Fund is designed to provide fellowships containing financial assistance up to \$2,500 for students seeking a Ph.D. degree in Psychology. Proposals exceeding \$2,500 will also be considered but may receive lower priority. The goal of the fellowship is to provide international experiences for ISU Psychology graduate students to enhance their professional development. Professional developmental activities that will be considered are international research presentations and workshops, international research collaboration, and international teaching experiences. It is also the Donor's hope that recipients of this fellowship shall be inspired to become philanthropic as they advance in their career and choose to provide similar opportunities to others. Students will be selected based on a proposal that addresses relevant selection criteria, detailed below.

The recipient is expected to send a proposal to Fred Borgen within one week after having been selected. Within one month of the recipient's return to the United States, the recipient will also be expected to write a 1–2-page summary of the experience and the benefits received. This summary will be posted on the ISU Psychology Department's website and will be sent to Fred Borgen, the Chair of the Department of Psychology, and for filing purposes, also to the Psychology Department's administrative assistant. In addition, the recipient is expected to present a summary of the experience (e.g., present their paper or an account of workshop experiences or research collaboration) in a relevant departmental seminar to which Fred Borgen will be invited.

The Chair of the Department of Psychology in consultation with the GPC (which includes members of the Department's Graduate Faculty and at least one graduate student) shall be responsible for the selection of the fellows. Given that most students travel in the summer, the primary application date for summer or fall travel will be **March 31**. If funds allow, additional fellowships may be awarded in the fall for spring semester travel. The deadline to apply for spring semester travel is **October 15**. The activities described in an application should occur within 16 months of the application deadline. If an award is not made in each semester, then the deadline can be extended.

To apply for the fellowship, the student should submit the proposal to the DOGE who will distribute them to GPC members. The proposal should be a 1-page statement of the intended international experience. The statement should include (a) the purpose and/or nature of the experience (i.e., conference presentation, research collaboration), (b) an abstract/summary of the student's presentation, workshop, research, or teaching activities that specifically highlight how the experience will enhance the student's professional development (see selection criteria listed below), (c) letter of support from the collaborating host, if applicable or notification of conference paper acceptance, (d) CV of student, (e) budget, and (f) signature of major professor indicating that the mentor has reviewed and supports the application.

Selection criteria include the following:

1. Benefit of international experience to student's long-term professional development
2. Significance, value, and quality of the experience
3. Scientific or pedagogical value of the experience

Information related to fellowship submissions that has been considered by the GPC in previous funding cycles includes the following:

- Order of authorship on the presentation
- Whether the presentation has been accepted yet
- International prominence of collaborating host
- Length of time student will be at the international site
- Strength of letter of support from collaborating host
- Student's previous international experience

To receive the fellowship the student must be (a) a full-time student pursuing his or her Ph.D. in Psychology and (b) in good academic standing. Graduate students on internship are also eligible to apply.

Baumann Summer Scholarship
(last modified February 2024)

The Baumann Summer Scholarship will provide 1 month of summer support for a graduate student in the

Department of Psychology at ISU. Students from any of the training areas within the department are eligible for the scholarship. This donor-funded scholarship was originally developed to support African American students and students with no other sources of funding for the summer. In 2024, the ISU Foundation revised this scholarship's memorandum of understanding in response to a report from the Iowa Board of Regents. Preference is now given to students who, through their experiences, activities, and academic work, will contribute to student body diversity, as determined by the administering authority and as permitted by Federal and State law and University policy. To qualify, a student should be in good standing at the time of the annual review of graduate students in May and be continuing in the program. To apply for the scholarship, students should submit a 1–2-page description of work that will be completed during the time of the award, a CV, a description of other summer support that the student has, and a letter of support from the major professor. The application and letter of support should be submitted to the DOGE by March 31 for full consideration. The scholarship may be used to support research related to the development of the student's program of research (e.g., manuscript preparation, data analysis, drafting of master's thesis) or other research or professional activities (e.g., visiting a collaborator's laboratory during the summer). The awardee will submit a 1–2-page summary of the work that was completed as part of the scholarship to the DOGE by October 1. Applications will be reviewed, and the awardee will be selected by the Graduate Program Committee. Preliminary notification of the award will be made in April or early May, and final notification will be made following the annual review of graduate students by the faculty of the Department of Psychology.

Dissertation Enhancement Grants

The purpose of these awards is to support student dissertations that require funds for research that are not available from faculty grants or other sources. Students are required to apply for small grants from other sources first, but if those applications are not funded, they may apply for dissertation funding from the department. These awards are contingent upon the availability of funds; the DOGE will announce their availability in August of each new academic year.

Funds may cover any of the following costs:

- a) the use of copyrighted instruments
- b) participant payments or incentives
- c) software or hardware needed for a study
- d) materials development
- e) copies

These funds may not be used for student travel or conference registration/participation.

Criteria:

- a. The student must submit evidence of application to other external grants. If those external grants are funded, the external funds must be used first, and any additional costs may be funded by the department grant.
- b. The student must be in good standing with the department.
- c. The proposal must be likely to result in a high-quality first-authored publication.
- d. The funds must be necessary to achieve the goals of the project.

Application:

The student must submit the following to be considered for a Dissertation Enhancement Award:

- a. A brief description of the proposed research (less than 3 pages)
- b. A budget and explanation of the purpose of the funds. The maximum amount available is up to \$2000, subject to available funds.
- c. Timetable for completion of the dissertation
- d. A CV
- e. Evidence of application (or intent to apply) for funding from other sources (see "Grants and Awards" page under "Graduate Program" on Department of Psychology website for possibilities). Applications for funding from other sources submitted after the application for the departmental dissertation grant must be confirmed with the DOGE.
- f. The applicant's advisor must provide a letter commenting on the following:
 - how far along the proposal is (i.e., is approved by the APC, or is it in very preliminary form?)
 - the necessity of the funding for completion of the project
 - the availability of funding elsewhere (e.g., from personal funds or faculty grant funds)
 - the feasibility of the project with and without this funding

- verify that the project is likely to result in a high-quality first authored publication and will significantly contribute to the student's long-term research career
- g. Funds will not be dispersed until the proposal has been approved by the student's APC. Applications must be submitted through Canvas by September 15th.

MISCELLANEOUS DUTY POOL (MDP)

(last modified April 2022)

What is MDP?

Throughout the semester, graduate students will perform several important functions associated with the undergraduate teaching mission of the department such as proctoring final exams and night exams, proctoring quizzes, and other related duties. Those of you who qualify for the MDP (see below) are scheduled for a certain number of commitments each semester. Nearly all MDP assignments are made as early as possible in the semester according to your availability. This allows you to add the assignments to your calendar along with your other regularly assigned recurring commitments.

The MDP Schedule

All MDP assignments are documented on a master MDP schedule which you will receive as early as possible in the semester. PLEASE review the schedule immediately and advise the Graduate Coordinator if you believe you have received an assignment in error. It is your responsibility to record all of your assignments into your own schedule and show up accordingly. As a courtesy, the MDP coordinator will send you a reminder of your upcoming assignments.

If for any reason you are unable to fulfill an assignment, you are responsible for finding a replacement. Inform the Graduate Coordinator that you will not be able to make the assignment and explain who the replacement is as soon as possible. The student who performs the MDP duty gets the credit, and the student who cannot fulfill their assignment (despite finding a replacement) does not receive the credit. Failure to fulfill an assignment without securing a replacement is noted during annual evaluations of students. Such failures may negatively impact your priority of future department funding.

Who Qualifies for MDP and who is Exempt?

- In general, if you receive all funding through the department (e.g., TA, GA, or fellowships awarded by the department), then you will receive a full MDP assignment for the year. If you are paid partially through the department and partially through grants, then you will receive a proportionate number of MDP assignments for the year.

If 20 hours or more of your funding is through the Student Counseling Services, Student Accessibility Services, or some other external unit, then you are exempt from MDP.

Submitting Your MDP Choices

1) General student schedule

At the start of each semester, we provide students who are required to do MDP with a list of assignments and asking them to characterize the list in terms of their availability and preferences. You will be asked to assign 1, 2, 3 or NA (not applicable) to each MDP task. 1 means that you are available and would prefer this assignment. 2 means that you can be available, but this is not a preferred assignment. 3 means that you are not available. Please note that if you indicate a 3, NOT AVAILABLE, this means that there is some prior commitment that cannot be changed. Examples are classes, practica, scheduled office hours, and scheduled GA times. Personal appointments and family responsibilities that cannot be easily changed may also be coded as 3s. (Note: The DOGE or Director of Undergraduate Studies will talk with any student who has 3s on 50% or more of the MDP assignments to verify that appropriate criteria were being used in assigning the 3s.). A student with a majority of 3s is likely to be heavily called upon during finals week. An NA means that you already are doing the assignment as part of your regular duties. For example, PSYCH 101 TAs proctor the PSYCH 101 night exams as part of their duties, so they would indicate NA for those assignments.

2) MDP scheduling and guidelines for finals week

There is a high demand for proctors during finals week. The MDP schedule for finals is not determined until later in the semester. The process will be similar for finals week. In addition, the following guidelines apply.

- GAs are paid through finals week and are expected to be available for proctoring throughout that week.
- The assumption for finals week is that you will be available anytime except when you are taking an exam or proctoring an exam.
- Supervision meetings with faculty or students should be scheduled around your assigned proctoring hours.
- You should not schedule trips, buy airline tickets, or schedule appointments (including appointments and meetings with faculty or students you supervise) that would conflict with your availability for MDP assignments during finals week.

Timely response to requests for your schedules and other information needed to develop the MDP calendar is critical to the success of the MDP program.

In case of a miss

When a graduate student misses an MDP assignment, the course instructor should contact the student and inquire about the reason for the missed assignment. Please cc the DOGE, the student's major professor, and the Graduate Coordinator in this email. Students who miss MDP assignments may put their funding in jeopardy.

MDP Points

A point system is used to assign a value to the MDP assignment according to the time commitment involved for each type of assignment. Day exams are worth 1.0 and night exams 1.5. Points are cumulative over the fall and spring semester each academic year and will carry-over to the following academic year, if applicable.

Following MDP guidelines helps ensure fair and smooth scheduling

We do everything possible to make MDP assignments as equitable as possible. Your adherence to MDP guidelines, particularly submitting schedules by the deadline assigned by the MDP Coordinator, is critical to ensure a seamless and fair process. We understand you have many significant commitments for your graduate program. MDP is valued and a component of that commitment. Failure to submit an accurate indication of your MDP availability by the prescribed deadline and/or failure to fulfill an assignment will be reflected in your annual evaluation and may negatively impact your priority of future department funding.

We understand that occasionally extenuating circumstances such as illness or family emergency may prevent you from fulfilling any single assignment (e.g., the proctoring of one quiz or one exam). In such emergencies, if at all possible, prior to missing the assignment, call/email the faculty member whose test will be affected. These cases should be discussed with the DOGE and/or the Graduate Coordinator.

Appealing for exemption from MDP

If you feel you have extenuating circumstances that would prevent you from fulfilling your MDP duties, you should discuss this with the DOGE, the Director of Undergraduate Students, or the Department Chair.

GLOSSARY

APC: Academic Plan Committee (chaired by major professor)

CV: curriculum vitae

DOGE: Director of Graduate Education, the person in the Department of Psychology who supervises the graduate program

GPC: Graduate Program Committee (composed of DOGE and representative faculty from each area).

MDP: Miscellaneous Duty Pool; the pool of students supported by the department who spent a portion of their assistantship helping with functions associated with the undergraduate teaching mission of the department such as proctoring final exams and night exams, proctoring quizzes, and other related duties

ANNUAL STUDENT REVIEW SUMMARY REPORT

Masters			
POSC Approved on (date):		Major Professor(s)	
Committee Members			
Masters on Ph.D. Track Form Completed		Thesis Proposal Accepted	
Masters Coursework Completed		Thesis Defense (Date/Outcome)	
Continuation to Ph.D. (Date/Outcome)		MS Conferred	
Thesis Title			

Ph.D.			
POSC Approved on (date):		Major Professor(s)	
Committee Members		PhD Coursework Completed	
Written Qualifying Exam (Date/Outcome)		Oral Qualifying Exam (Date/Outcome)	
Dissertation Proposal Accepted		Dissertation Defense (Date/Outcome)	
PhD Conferred		First Position/Internship (Date, Site)	
Dissertation Title			

MS Requirements: Psych 5010, Stat 5101, Psych 6990, plus 18 credits in Psych, with at least one course from 2 of first 5 core groups.

PhD Requirements: Psych 5010, Stat 5101 and 5212/5820, Psych 6990, plus one course from at least 4 of the 7 core groups.

If a course is not listed but satisfy degree requirements, you may add them to this table (e.g., 5980, which can be one of the 18-credits in Psych).

Grades in Core Courses					
Total Credits Taken	Overall GPA/Core GPA (Report Both, separate by /)				
1. Biological	510/517/519:	NUTRS 589X:			
2. Cognitive	516:				
3. Social	580:				
4. Indiv Diff	560:	561/661:			
5. Applied	521/HCI 621:	542:	595B/683:	595C:	
6. History	505/601:				
7. Teaching	633:				
8. Research Methods	501:				
9. Statistics	5101:	5820:			
10. Statistics (intention to receive quantitative certificate)					

Intended Career Setting	
Academia ☐ Clinical Practice ☐ Industry ☐ Other (Specify):	
Short-term (within the next year) goals related to student's progress (e.g., thesis, submit manuscript for publication, secure summer internship, etc). Refresh this section each year – do not append from previous years.	
1.	
2.	
3.	
4.	
5.	
6.	
7.	
8.	

Research (Cumulative Record)

1. Provide the reference for each journal article or book chapter (published or in press), in APA format, for which the student is sole or co-author. Identify with an asterisk all projects that are not part of the thesis or dissertation.

2. Provide the reference for each conference presentation (paper or poster), in APA format, for which the student participated.

3. Describe the student's current research activities.

Fellowships or Grant Applications/Awards (Cumulative Record)

List each fellowship or grant the student has applied for or received. Indicate the amount of the award and active years. Briefly describe what was required for the application (# of pages, budget, etc.).

Teaching (Cumulative Record)

List all courses taught by the student (including semester/year) and indicate whether the student was the sole instructor or a co-instructor.

**Practica, Internships, Professional Workshops,
and other Professional Experiences (Cumulative Record)**

List each relevant experience by year. For practica, include the placement site and course number.

**Service to the Department, College, University, Community,
or Professional Associations (Cumulative Record)**

List each service role or activity by year. Briefly describe the nature of the service role and entity that was supported.

Student Outcome Information

After finalizing the annual review, please complete the following information to be used in the annual Graduate Student Outcomes Report.

Total # of conference presentations (including posters) since the student came to ISU (do not count upcoming ones):	
Total # of peer-reviewed publications (excluding encyclopedia entries) since the student came to ISU:	
Of the previous number of publications, how many are first-authored publications?	
Total # of ISU courses taught by the student (if co-taught, it counts as 0.5):	
If student is graduating, please provide graduation date (e.g., Spring 2016):	
External awards (type, years, amount):	
Describe the student employment after graduation, including employer, job title, and location or post-doc position information:	

Major Professor's Summary Comments			
Recommendation:		☐ Continue in Program ☐ Conditional Continuation ☐ Probation ☐ Dismissal	
The Graduate Student and Major Professor met to discuss the student's annual review form, their professional goals and development plan, as well as the mentor-mentee relationship.		Date:	
Major Professor's Signature:		Date:	
Student's Signature:		Date:	

MASTER'S ACADEMIC PLAN COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION FOR CONTINUATION TO DOCTORAL STUDIES

Student: _____

Program: _____

Entered (Semester/Year): _____

Major Professor(s): _____

Committee Members: _____

Recommendation of Committee:

_____ Continue (Vote: _____)

_____ Not Continue (Vote: _____)

GPA/Credits:

_____ psych core courses

_____ other psych courses

_____ outside courses

Thesis title:

Summary and Evaluation of Research Activity:

Summary and Evaluation of Professional Activity:

Other Comments:
